Figurative Language

Year 5 Accelerated — 11+ Lesson Worksheet (PassFrame Tuition)

Worked examples — tutor talks through these first

Easy: Identify the device: The kitten was as fluffy as a cloud.
Method & answer: It compares two things using 'as ... as'. Answer: simile.

Standard: Identify the device: The classroom was a zoo.
Method & answer: It says one thing IS another, with no 'like' or 'as'. Answer: metaphor.

Advanced: Identify the device: The wind whispered through the trees.
Method & answer: The wind is given a human ability (whispering). Answer: personification.

Easy / Standard — *work through together, answer 5 in the lesson* ⏱ *15 min (1 min per question)*

1. Identify the device: Her smile was as bright as the sun.

2. Identify the device: The stars danced in the sky.

3. Identify the device: Peter Piper picked a peck of pickled pepper.

4. Which figurative device is used in 'Time is money'? A) simile B) metaphor C) personification D) alliteration

5. Identify the device: The snow was like a soft white blanket.

6. Identify the device: The old car groaned as it climbed the hill.

7. Identify the device: Sally sells seashells by the seashore.

8. Identify the device: He is a couch potato.

9. Which two words usually signal a simile? A) is / was B) like / as C) the / a D) and / but

10. Does a metaphor use 'like' or 'as'? A) Yes, always B) No — a metaphor says one thing IS another, without 'like' or 'as' C) Only sometimes D) Only in poetry

11. Identify the device: The thunder growled angrily overhead.

12. Select ALL the figurative devices used in 'As brave as a lion, she faced her fears': A) simile B) metaphor C) personification D) alliteration E) onomatopoeia

13. Identify the device: Busy bees buzzed beside the blossoms.

14. Which figurative device is used in 'My brother is a pig when he eats'? A) simile B) metaphor C) personification D) alliteration

15. What does personification do to a non-human thing?

Standard — *work through together, answer 5 in the lesson* ⏱ *15 min (1 min per question)*

1. Write an extended metaphor (two or more connected images) describing a storm as a wild animal.

6. Which device is used in 'Her patience was a thread stretched to breaking point'? A) Simile B) Metaphor — comparing patience to a thread about to snap suggests it is fragile and close to running out C) Personification D) Alliteration

11. Explain why writers sometimes mix a simile within an otherwise literal, non-figurative passage, rather than using figurative language throughout.

2. Which device is used in 'Fear was a cold hand gripping her heart', and why is it more powerful than a simile here? A) Metaphor — stating fear IS a hand (not 'like' a hand) makes the image feel more direct and intense B) Simile — using 'like' softens the comparison C) Personification only D) Alliteration

3. Select ALL the devices used in 'The greedy flames devoured the forest hungrily': A) personification (flames given the traits of being greedy and devouring hungrily) B) simile C) alliteration D) onomatopoeia E) rhyme

4. Explain why 'The silence was deafening' is an oxymoron rather than a simple contradiction, and what effect it creates.

5. Write a sentence using both a simile and alliteration to describe rain.

7. Explain the difference between personification and an extended metaphor, using an example of each.

8. Identify the device and explain why it might feel clichéd, then suggest a fresher alternative: 'Her eyes sparkled like diamonds.'

9. Which device is used in 'Opportunity is a door that opens only once'? A) Simile B) Metaphor — comparing opportunity to a door suggests it is something you must act on quickly, or lose access to forever C) Personification D) Alliteration

10. Write a personification sentence for the sea that also uses a verb suggesting violence or anger.

12. Which device is used in 'Guilt was a stone in his stomach'? A) Simile B) Metaphor — comparing guilt to a heavy stone suggests a constant, weighty, uncomfortable feeling C) Personification D) Alliteration

13. Correct this description so it becomes a metaphor rather than a simile, keeping the same comparison: 'The city at night was like a galaxy of lights.'

14. Explain why alliteration alone, without other figurative devices, can still make writing more powerful. Give an example.

15. Identify the device and explain the effect: 'The old house held its breath, waiting.'

Standard / Hard — *work through together, answer 5 in the lesson* ⏱ *15 min (1 min per question)*

1. Which device is used in 'The city was a jungle of concrete and steel'? A) simile B) metaphor C) personification D) alliteration

2. Identify the device and explain the effect: The old house groaned and creaked as if it were alive.

3. What is an extended metaphor?

4. Which device is used in 'The fog

6. Explain why 'The classroom was a zoo' is more powerful than 'The classroom was like a zoo' in most contexts.

7. Identify the device: Ferocious, fire-breathing dragons flew fearlessly overhead.

8. Select ALL the devices used in 'The angry sea roared like a lion': A) personification (the sea is 'angry' and 'roars') B) simile ('like a lion') C) alliteration D) onomatopoeia E) rhyme

9. Identify the device and explain

11. Which device is used in 'Her heart was a block of ice'? A) simile B) metaphor — suggesting she was completely emotionless or cold-hearted C) personification D) alliteration

12. Write a personification sentence to describe a fierce storm.

13. Which device is used in 'The exam loomed over her like a dark shadow'? A) simile — comparing the exam's threatening presence to a looming shadow, suggesting dread and anxiety B) metaphor C) personification D) alliteration

14. Explain why a writer might

crept in like a thief in the night'? A) simile — comparing the fog's movement to a thief, suggesting it arrived quietly and unnoticed B) metaphor C) personification only D) alliteration

5. Identify the device and explain the effect: Guilt gnawed at his conscience.

the effect: Opportunity knocked, but he was too afraid to answer the door.

10. Explain why alliteration is often used in poetry and advertising.

choose a metaphor over a simile when describing a character's anger.

15. Identify the device and explain the effect: The wind's icy fingers clawed at the windows.